

Gustavo Guallar

A time you helped a team member adapt to a change:

Change is inevitable in any organization, and staying flexible is extremely important. I have experienced many changes, including recent ones at CarMax, which have required me to adapt to new situations.

In my previous role as Pinkerton Security manager, I experienced organizational restructuring that impacted team members and required them to adapt.

One of those instances involved the downside of a team that I was directly involved in its creation, from hiring to team activation.

The team comprised nine members who protected the client from 7:00 a.m. to 11:00 p.m. They operated from two unarmed stationary towers and one armed patrol on the parking lot, supporting the client's loss prevention team.

I was very proud of the team and pleased with its performance; the team operated beyond expectations.

The client's loss prevention team expanded, and thirty days before the renewal of the service contract, I received a notification from the client requesting a restructuring of security services. This change will significantly reduce service hours, which will impact team members financially and lead to changes in schedules and locations. These adjustments will seriously affect the team and need to be discussed with them immediately.

It was evident to me that, during these changes, my responsibility was to help the team navigate the transition while maintaining cohesion.

I promptly shared the information with the team and assured them that I would discuss the specific changes with them after confirming the details with the client.

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I needed to gather more information from the team to provide options that minimize the impact of the changes . Therefore, I held individual conversations with each team member to address their concerns. I asked how the changes would affect their roles, what impact a shift in schedule might have on them, and how a reduction in hours could affect them financially.

Additionally, I inquired whether they would be willing to train with another team to compensate for any lost work hours.

I informed the team members that these changes would impact them, but they also presented new opportunities with other accounts.

I explained that I would offer them the option of paid training with another team at a different location, allowing them to recover lost work hours by working with another team in another location .

Additionally, I offer them the chance to train as part of the Flex Team. Members of the Flex Team received higher pay because they trained across multiple teams and could perform any role within any of those teams.

In conclusion, when the time came to implement the changes, some team members had already completed their training and were ready to transition to another team, while others chose to adapt to the changes and remain in their current roles.

Understanding their perspective on the changes and how they affected each individual team member allowed me to help them better navigate and adapt to them .